STANDARD 7

LIFE SKILLS

Simplified notes

This document contains a simplified version of Standard 7 notes. The notes were written by Juma Ali a teacher at Msinjiri Primary School, Malombe Zone, MANGOCHI.

The notes were extracted from the PCAR versions of Life skills books for Standard 7.

UNIT 1

BASIC FACTS ABOUT SEXUALLY TRANSMITTED INFECTIONS (STI'S) INCLUDING HIV AIDS

FACTORS THAT INFLUENCE THE YOUTH TO HAVE SEXUAL RELATIONSHIPS

- *Peer pressure*
- *Lack of information*
- *Desire for sexual experimentation*
- *Curiosity*
- *Physical and emotional changes*
- *Cultural pressure*

CONSEQUENCES OF SEXUAL RELATIONSHIPS

- *STI's*
- *Unwanted pregnancies*
- *School dropouts*

WHAT ARE SEXUALLY TRANSIMITTED INFECTIONS

- *Are infections that can be transmitted through body contacts during unprotected sex between an infected person and a healthy person*

COMMON SEXUALLY TRANSMITTED INFECTIONS

- *Gonorrhoea*
- *Syphilis*
- *Herpes*
- *Hepatitis*
- *Candidiasis*

PROBLEMS ASSOCIATED WITH HIV AIDS

- *Absenteeism from work and school and work*
- *Reduction in productivity which leads to under development of the country*
- *Congestion in hospitals*
- *Poverty*
- *Discrimination*
- *School dropout*
- *Opharnhood*
- *Loss of skilled personnel*

MANAGING PROBLEMS ASSOCIATED WITH HIV AND AIDS

- *Encouraging people to go for HTC through seeking early treatment.*
- *Introducing home based care units*

- *Sensitising people on income generating activities*
- *Showing love and care to patient*
- *Forming HIV and AIDS groups for access to basic needs and support*
- *Providing guidance and counselling*
- *Establishing orphanage centres*

MODES OF TRANSIMISSION

- *Unprotected sexual intercourse with an infected partner*
- *Transfusion of contaminated blood*
- *Common usage of contaminated or unsterilized sharp tools*
- *Mother to child transmission during pregnancy, delivery and breastfeeding.*

EFFECTS OF STI's and HIV AIDS

- *Destruction of body organs*
- *Miscarriages*
- *Cervical cancer*
- *Ectopic pregnancy*
- *Baby born blind*

PREVENTION OF STI's INCLUDING HIV and AIDS

- *Having protected sex by using condoms properly*
- *HIV testing and Counselling*
- *Improving genital hygiene*
- *Abstinence from casual sex*
- *Being faithful to uninfected partner*

UNIT 2

HIV TESTING AND COUNSELLING

ROLE OF HIV TESTING AND COUNSELLING

- *Knowing one's HIV status results in positive behavioural change whether one is infected or not.*
- *Those who test positive receive counselling and are encouraged to protect themselves and others from further infection. They are encouraged to seek medical, social and psychological support from health practitioners, religious leaders and other around.*

- *Those who test negative still undergo counselling. This help them maintain their negative status.*

PROCESS OF HTC

HIV test is to detect antibodies to HIV. Antibodies are produced when a bacteria or virus infects the body. It takes 3 to 6 months after exposure to HIV AIDS for a test to detect these antibodies. The following is the process of HTC:

- *Client is first counselled and this is known as pre-counselling*
- *Client is tested on a sample of blood to detect antibodies for HIV*
- *Client undergo post counselling*
- *Client is told of the test results*

HIV TEST RESULTS

- *A test can be HIV-negative or HIV-positive*
- *If you test HIV-negative, it probably means that you are not infected, but it could also means you took the test too soon after exposure to HIV for antibodies to have developed. It is advisable to take the test again.*
- *If you test HIV-positive, it is almost certain that you are infected*.

BARRIERS TO HTC

- *Testing facilities are very scarce*
- *Stigma of HIV infection*
- *Lack of information*
- *Perception of low risk*
- *Lack of confidentiality*
- *Transportation problems*

WAYS OF OVERCOMING BARRIERS TO HTC

- *People should be encouraged to be open and take AIDS as many other disease*
- *Sensitise people on the importance of HTC*
- *Publicise all the HTC centres in the area.*
- *Government should establish more centres throughout the country.*

UNIT 3

GENDER AND HIV AND AIDS

HOW GENDER ROLES ARE IMPARTED BY THE SOCIETY

- *Parents encourage gender discrimination*

- *Girls are often given toys like plates and cups while boys are given cars and trains*
- *Men are considered to be producers, constructors, tough and competitive.*

SEX ROLES

A biological or natural role performed by either male or females that need to be recognised and respected. e.g childbearing for females, fathering the child for males.

GENDER STEREOTYPE

A socially or culturally prescribed set of expectations about the roles of males and females which have no basis in their real capacities e.g women are supposed to say "yes" to sex even if they do not want to. On the other hand men are supposed to propose love and demand for sex from women.

WHY MORE FEMALES THAN MEN ARE AFFECTED AND INFECTED BY HIV and AIDS

- *Most women do not have reliable sources of income*
- *They cannot negotiate for safer sex*
- *Because of their biological make make up*

UNIT 4

HOME BASED CARE AND SUPPORT

Home based care involves the provision of nutritional, emotional, psychological and spiritual support to a person suffering from HIV AIDS related diseases or any other long illness.

PROBLEMS ASSOCIATED WITH HOME BASED CARE AND SUPPORT

- *Inadequate knowledge on nutritious foods and how to take care of the patients*
- *Lack of finances to buy materials*
- *Inadequate supply of drugs*
- *Lack of conducive environment of the patient*
- *Lack of follow up by medical personal*
- *Stigmatisation*
- *Inadequate psychological, emotional and spiritual support by the community.*

WAYS OF MANAGING PROBLEMS ASSOCIATED WITH HOME BASED CARE AND SUPPORT

- *Train the care providers on how to take care of the patient*
- *Lobbying for financial support from well wishers*
- *Mobilise the community for help in establishing drug revolving fund*
- *Providing a conducive environment by cleaning the surrounding and digging pit latrines*

- *The community should persuade medical personal to visit the patient as frequent as possible.*
- *Sensitising the community to have love and care for the patients as frequent as possible.*
- *Sensitising the community to have love and care for the patient*
- *Intensifying psychological, emotional and spiritual support for the patient.*

IMPORTANCE OF HOME BASED CARE AND SUPPORT

- *Proper care is provided for the infected and affected person in a familiar environment*
- *It is cost effective*
- *It allows more people to be involved in caring for the patients*
- *It reduces overcrowding in the hospitals*
- *It helps the family members and the community to accept the epidemic*
- *It gives chance to guardians to do other activities while looking after the other patient.*
- *It relieves the government of the pressure it faces on the number of health personal bed space and shortage of drugs.*

UNIT 5

PEACEFUL CONFLICT RESOLUTION

WAYS OF RESOLVING CONFLICTS PEACEFULLY

- Negotiation

It is a process where people who are involved in a conflicts come together and talk to each other about the conflict.

- Mediation

Is a process where two persons who are in a conflict involve a third person to help them come up with a solution.

- Arbitration

Is a process where two persons involved in a conflict involve a third person who acts like a judge as he or she gives the final judgement as to who is right or wrong?

BARRIERS TO PEACEFUL CONFLICT RESOLUTION

- *Prejudice*
- *Intolerance*
- *Discrimination*
- *Gender*

- *Inequality*
- *Pride*
- *Bribery*

WAYS OF OVERCOMING BARRIERS TO PEACEFUL CONFLICT RESOLUTION

- *Not being prejudiced*
- *Not being discriminatory*
- *Being tolerant*
- *Being respectful of other people's ideas*
- *Respecting other people's ideas*
- *Respecting other people's customs*
- *Being patient*
- *Dealing with an issue at hand objectively and transparently*
- *Being assertive*
- *Promoting justice*
- *Promoting gender equality*

UNIT 6

INTERPERSONAL RELATIONSHIPS

Interpersonal relationships is the way people relate, associate or interact with one another.

TYPES OF INTERPERSONAL RELATIONSHIPS

- *Relationship within the family*
- *Relationship among peers*
- *Relationship among juniors or seniors*
- *Relationships between males and females*

FACTORS THAT DESTROY RELATIONSHIPS

- *Envy*
- *Dishonesty*
- *Gossip*
- *Jealousy*
- *Poverty*
- *Violence*
- *Sexual harassment*
- *Poor communication*
- *Rudeness*

- *Disrespect*
- *Unfulfilled promises*
- *Gender inequality*
- *Theft*
- *Lies*
- *Property grabbing*
- *Change of status*
- *Witchcraft*
- *Abuse of human rights*

FACTORS THAT MAY ENHANCE OF RELATIONSHIPS

- *Love*
- *Empathy*
- *Economic status*
- *Respect*
- *Effective communication*
- *Politeness*
- *Tolerance*
- *Care*
- *Gender*
- *Sensitivity*
- *Observation of human rights*
- *Honesty*
- *Co-operation*

UNIT 7

EFFECTIVE COMMUNICATION ON HIV AIDS

FACTORS THAT ENHANCE EFFECTIVE COMMUNICATION ON HIV AIDS

- *Choice of channel of communication*
- *Choice of language*
- *Audience*
- *Tolerance*
- *Patience*
- *Empathy*
- *Negotiation*

BARRIERS TO EFFECTIVE COMMUNICATION ON HIV AIDS MESSAGES

- *Illiteracy*

- *Lack of knowledge*
- *Gender bias*
- *Low self esteem*
- *Poor channel of communication*
- *Age*
- *Religion*
- *Language*
- *Stress and anxiety*
- *Noise*
- *Social status*

WAYS OF OVERCOMING BARRIERS TO EFFECTIVE COMMUNICATION ON HIV AIDS

- *Appropriate words*
- *Mutual respect*
- *Appropriate channel*
- *Avoiding prejudice*
- *Being objective*
- *Improvement of literacy levels*
- *Respect for other peoples culture*
- *Being knowledgeable on HIV AIDS*

UNIT 8

SUPPORTING THE LESS PRIVILEGED

THE LESS PRIVILEGED

The less privileged are people who lack opportunities or advantages enjoyed by other members in communities.

EXAMPLES OF LESS PRIVILEGED PEOPLE

- *Orphans*
- *The aged*
- *The physically and mentally challenged*
- *Street children*
- *Widows*
- *The sick including those with HIV AIDS*

NEEDS OF THE LESS PRIVILEGED

- *Food*
- *Shelter*
- *Clothes*

- *Soap*
- *Beddings*
- *Medication*
- *Education*
- *Spiritual support*
- *Moral support*
- *Love*
- *Care*
- *Protection*

WAYS OF ASSISTING THE LESS PRIVILEGED

- *Provision of adequate and nutritious food*
- *A reasonable clean home*
- *Adequate clothes*
- *Washing and bathing soap*
- *Blankets*
- *Adequate medical attention*
- *Spiritual and moral support*
- *Education*
- *Income Generating Activities training*
- *Need to be loved and cared for*

UNIT 9

DRUG AND SUBSTANCE ABUSE

MISCONCEPTIONS ASSOCIATED WITH THE USE AND ABUSE OF DRUGS AND SUBSTANCES

- *Drug and substance abuse make one intelligent.*
- *Drugs make someone forget his or her problems.*
- *Drugs are fashionable.*
- *Drugs makes someone feel energetic.*

SITUATIONS THAT PROMOTE ABUSE OF DRUGS AND SUBSTANCES

- *Culture*
- *Poverty and unemployment*
- *Loneliness*
- *Negative peer pressure*

HOW ABUSE OF DRUGS AND SUBSTANCES CAN EXPOSE YOUTH TO HIV AND AIDS

- *Engaging themselves in unprotected sexual intercourse because of loss of self-control*
- *Using unsterilized needles to inject each other*

UNIT 11

DECISION MAKING AND PROBLEM SOLVING

SITUATIONS THAT REQUIRE DECISION MAKING AND PROBLEM SOLVING SKILLS

- *Adolescence*
- *Sexual relationships*
- *Peer pressure*
- *Cultural practices*
- *Conflicts*

EFFECTS OF WRONG DECISION MAKING AND PROBLEM SOLVING

SITUATION	EFFECTS ON THE YOUTH
Adolescence	• Immoral behaviour leading to contracting STIs including HIV AIDS
Sexual relationships	• Unwanted pregnancies • Arbortion • School dropout • Contracting STIs
Negative peer pressure	• Lead to drug and substance abuse • Crime • Suicide • Contraction of STIs • Unwanted pregnancies
Cultural practices	• Forced marriages • Early marriages • Contraction of STI's

WAYS OF RESOLVING CONFLICTS AMONG THE YOUTH AND PARENTS

- *Provision of guidance and counselling*

- *Another person initiating a friendly discussion in which the parent and the youth will discuss their problems*
- *Both sides or one of them accepting ideas from the other side*
- *The parent and the youth having the spirit of putting oneself into another's situation.*

THE IMPORTANCE OF DECISION MAKING AND PROBLEM SOLVING WHEN RESOLVING CONFLICT AMONG THE YOUTH AND PARENTS

- *Helps a person analyse an issue and think critically about it in order to solve it in order to solve it.*

UNIT 10

PEER GUIDANCE AND COUNSELLING

- *Is where members of the same age group come together to help one another solve their problem.*

CHALLENGES THAT YOUTH ENCOUNTER

- *Sexual abuse*
- *Drug and substance abuse*
- *Orphan hood*

ADRESSING CHALLENGES THAT YOUTH ENCOUNTER

- *They must be helped to develop high self-esteem.*
- *They also need to accept new situations.*

UNIT 12

STRESS AND ANXIETY

SITUATIONS THAT MA LEAD TO STRESS AND ANXIETY

- *Child abuse*
- *Too much work*
- *Death of a loved one*
- *Adolescence*

- *Academic failure*
- *Poverty*
- *Teenage pregnancy*
- *Divorce*
- *Bullying or teasing and unfaithfulness*

EFFECTS OF STRESS AND ANXIETY

- *Suicide*
- *Abortion*
- *Prostitution*
- *Mental confusion*
- *Depression*
- *Theft*
- *Alcohol*
- *Drug Abuse*
- *Violence*
- *School dropout*

WAYS OF MANAGING STRESS AND ANXIETY

- *Having enough rest*
- *Playing games*
- *Exercising*
- *Seeking counselling*
- *Talking and interacting with people*
- *Learning to relax properly both mentally and physically*
- *Watching TV*
- *Listening to music*
- *Reading books*

UNIT 13

SELF ESTEEM AND ASSERTIVENESS

FACTORS THAT PROMOTE HIGH SELF ESTEEM

- *Constructive criticism*
- *Accepting guidance and counselling*
- *Awareness of oneself*
- *Avoiding gender*
- *Religion*

- *Tribal*
- *Disability*
- *Stereotyping*
- *Rewards*
- *Success in one's plans*
- *Supportive school and home environment*

CHARACTERISTICS OF PEOPLE WITH HIGH SELF ESTEEM

- *Self-awareness*
- *Facing challenges positively*
- *Thinking critically*
- *Enjoying work*
- *Having direction and purpose in life*
- *Being ambitious*
- *Avoiding conflicts*

CHARACTERISTICS OF PEOPLE WITH LOW SELF ESTEEM

- *Fear of facing challenging situations*
- *Showing aggressiveness as defence mechanism*
- *Counting on others to think on one's behalf*
- *Lack of critical thinking*
- *Fear of making mistakes*
- *Not enjoying work*
- *Lack of direction or purpose in life*

IMPORTANCE OF ASSERTIVENESS

- *Avoid social problems*
- *Avoid health problems such as STIs including HIV and AIDS*
- *Achieve set goals*
- *Promote one's identity*
- *Get more of what one wants*
- *Feel good about oneself*

HOW HIGH SELF ESTEEM PROMOTE ASSERTIVENESS

It makes one stand firm in achieving one's goals in life

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UNIT 14

PHYSICAL AND PSYCHOLOGICAL CHANGES DURING ADOLESCENCE

Meaning of Adolescence

- *It is the dynamic physical and psychological change.*

Meaning Of Puberty

- *It is when a boy or girl's features start to change from the body of a child to that of an adult.*

Physical and psychological changes boys and girls during adolescence.

Changes in boys

Physical Changes	**Psychological Changes**
- *growing taller and heavier* - *the hands and shoulders grow bigger and stronger* - *the penis and testis increase in size* - *The penis becomes erect more often and there may be wet dreams.* - *The skin becomes oily and pimples grow on face.* - *Hair grows around pubic area, arm pits and eventually on the face and chest.* - *The voice becomes deeper*	- *they prefer to be treated like adults and want to make their own decisions* - *They develop more self-confidence.* - *They do not like to be forced to do things they do not want.* - *Develop sexual feelings and getting excited on seeing a girl.* - *Interest in girls increases and start to take extra care on how they look.* - *There are frequent changes in mood and sensitive to their appearance* - *They develop increased sensitivity to failure.* - *They become sensitive to remarks from adults and peers about their changes.*

Changes in girls

Physical Changes	**Psychological changes**
- *Grow faster* - *Hips get wider* - *Breasts start to grow* - *Skin becomes oily* - *Pimples develop on the face* - *Hair grows around the vagina* - *Hair grows around the armpits* - *They experience first menstruation*	- *They develop sexual feelings and get excited on seeing a boy.* - *Interest in boys increases and they want to take extra care on how they look.* - *They develop more self confidence and not like to do things they do not want, they want to be treated like*

- *Enlargement of the labia and clitoris* - *Ovaries get bigger and developed.* - *Voice becomes soft*	*adults and want to make their own decisions.* - *They become sensitive to remarks from adults and peers about their changes.* - *Frequent changes in mood occur* - *They become increasingly sensitive to failure* - *Sexual curiosity – desire to know more about sexual organs especially of opposite sex.* - *Keen on reading books concerning sex and other social activities* - *Desire for independence from parents and other adults.* - *Feeling of love or hate*

UNIT 15

SEX AND SEXUALITY

Sex refer's to one's reproductive system which differentiates males from females.

Sexuality is the total expression of who one is as a human being whether male or female. It involves one's psycho-socio development. That is one's values, mental attitudes, physical appearance, beliefs, emotion's, personality, likes, dislikes, one's spiritual self and all the ways in which one has been socialised. Sexuality is part of them from birth to death.

Sources of information on sex and sexuality;

- *Parents*
- *Mass media*
- *Peers*
- *Community*
- *Religion*

Consequences of misinformation on sex and sexuality

- *Increasing the possibility of contracting STI's including HIV and AIDS.*

Importance of having appropriate information on sex and sexuality

- *It helps the youth to cope with problems that come with adolescence.*
- *It helps the youth to avoid getting involved in sexual relationships.*

UNIT 16

PLANNING

A Plan is a self-disciplining guideline to ensure that activities are carried out efficiently.

Stages in Planning

1. *Identifying goals*
2. *Organising resources*
3. *Choosing course of action*
4. *Implementing the plan*
5. *Monitoring*

Importance of Planning

- *It assist to save time, material and money.*
- *It is also easier to achieve set goals through planning.*
- *It assist to refrain from risky behaviours.*

Situations that require Planning

- *Choice of career*
- *Marriage*
- *Family*
- *Business*
- *Safe motherhood*

Situations that can change plans

- *Dropping out of school*
- *Early marriages*
- *Peer pressure*
- *Lack of resources*
- *Death*
- *Rainfall patterns*
- *Stress and anxiety*
- *Natural disasters*